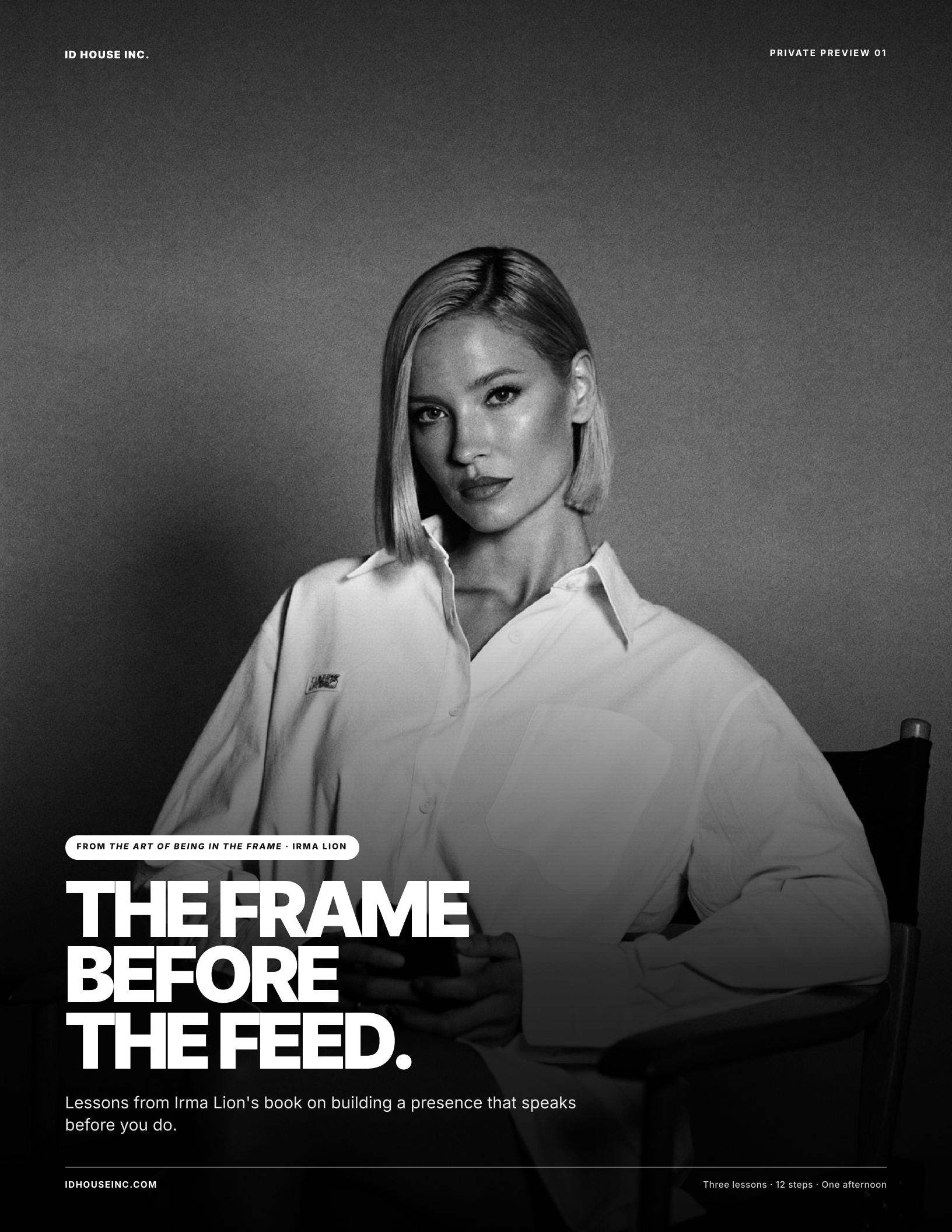


FROM *THE ART OF BEING IN THE FRAME* · IRMA LION

THE FRAME BEFORE THE FEED.

Lessons from Irma Lion's book on building a presence that speaks before you do.

THIS BEGAN BEHIND A CAMERA.

For eighteen years, Irma Lion has watched people step into her frame.

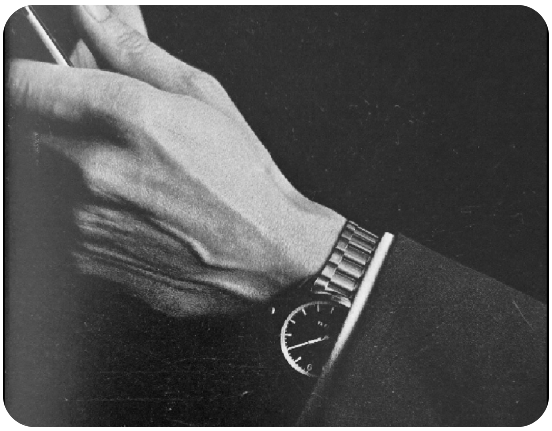
Fashion sets in Belarus. A living-room studio in Kansas City. Editorial work in California. She watched people get nervous, try to look right, and hide.

Then she watched what happened when they stopped performing. Their shoulders dropped. Their eyes changed. The image came alive.

The Art of Being in the Frame is her upcoming book about that moment, and how to build a brand from it. This preview pulls its branding lessons and turns them into steps. **The ideas are Irma's. The steps are how we apply them for clients at ID House.**

FROM THE BOOK
IRMA LION · CHAPTER 03

Most people approach personal branding backwards. They start with the outside. … The outside can only hold what the inside gives it.



YOUR BRAND SPEAKS FIRST.

A prospect hears your name in a referral, on a podcast, in a comment. Then they tap. In seconds they read your photo, your name, one line of bio and the top of your grid. Before a single caption, they have filed you: the expert, the hobbyist, or someone to check back on.

Irma defines a brand as *"the perception, feeling, and experience people associate with you, before you even say a word."* Most profiles try to fix that feeling from the outside. This preview starts where she does: inside.

WHAT A STRANGER READS, IN ORDER

1	Photo and name. Who is this?
2	Bio, line one. What do they believe?
3	The link. What do I do next?
4	Highlights. Can I trust them?
5	Top row of the grid. Show me.

OUR RULE

Truth before tactics.
Know what you stand for, then let every surface say it.

WHAT IT IS NOT

Not a growth hack.
No trends, no tricks, no posting twice a day.

TIME IT TAKES

One afternoon.
Then fifteen minutes a week to keep it honest.

WHICH PROFILE ARE YOU

FOUR WAYS TO HIDE IN PLAIN SIGHT.

Irma has photographed thousands of people. Most of them, at first, were hiding. Online it looks like one of these four. Pick yours. Steps marked with your letter change slightly for you.

G The Ghost

Looks like: an old photo, a bio from two roles ago, a last post from months back.

Underneath: you've changed, and the profile hasn't caught up. Irma calls branding *"learning how to recognize yourself as you change."*

Needs: proof of life. Start with Lesson 1, then a new photo and bio before any new post.

A The Gallery

Looks like: beautiful images, few words. People admire it and still can't say what you do.

Underneath: beauty without a point of view. In the book, beauty *"is presence. It is emotion."* It still needs a sentence.

Needs: words. A bio that names what you believe, captions with a point.

D The Diary

Looks like: warm, personal, full of life. Followers feel like friends. Few know you're for hire.

Underneath: *"Authenticity without clarity can still leave people unsure of what you offer."*

Needs: positioning. Keep the personality. Add proof and a clear invitation.

B The Billboard

Looks like: every post sells. Links, launches, limited spots. Reach is flat. DMs are quiet.

Underneath: proving, not communicating. *"Proving turns the audience into a judge."*

Needs: trust before the ask. Give more, ask once, move the offer to highlights.



HOW THIS PREVIEW WORKS

Lesson 1 · Find what is true	What you stand for. Chapters 02 and 03.
Lesson 2 · Reveal your voice	How your profile sounds. Chapter 04.
Lesson 3 · Align your work	What every post proves. Chapters 07, 09, 12.
Then	A fifteen-minute audit you can run every Monday.

STAND FOR SOMETHING FIRST.

FROM THE BOOK
IRMA LION · CHAPTER 03

Write down three things you will not compromise. In your work. In your relationships. In your brand. These are not preferences. They are positions. That is where your voice lives.

Four steps. Three core. Twenty minutes with a pen, before you touch your profile. Everything after this page is built from what you write here.

Values
STEP 01

Choose three values you would build a life around. CORE

Not the ones that sound impressive. Irma's are freedom, beauty and honesty, and you can see all three in her work. Write what each looks like on an ordinary Tuesday. They become your filter: what you post, who you work with, what you decline.

The line
STEP 02

Name three things you will not compromise. CORE

The clients you won't take. The content you won't make. The shortcut you won't use. Positions give a brand edges, and edges are what people remember.

Role vs. self
STEP 03

Separate what you do from who you are.

"The photographer is what I do. Irma is who I am." List your roles. A profile built only on roles reads like a résumé. Roles go in your name field as proof. Who you are goes in everything else.

Point of view
STEP 04

Turn your topic into a belief. CORE

"A topic is what you talk about. A point of view is what you believe about it." Finish one line: *I believe...* or *Most people in my field are taught...* This sentence becomes your bio line one and your first pinned post.

G do this page before anything else on your profile.

TOPIC VS. POINT OF VIEW

Topic: fundraising.

Point of view: Investors don't fund ideas. They fund founders they can picture still standing in five years.

YOUR FOUNDATION

My three values: _____ · _____ · _____

I will not compromise: _____

I believe: _____

SOUND LIKE YOU, NOT YOUR INDUSTRY.

FROM THE BOOK
IRMA LION · CHAPTER 04

Your voice is not something you manufacture. It is something you notice. … You do not need to sound louder. You need to sound more like yourself.

Photo
STEP 05

A face, close, unperformed. CORE

Irma can always see the difference between someone performing and someone being. So can a stranger. Shoulders up, eyes visible, plain background. Choose the frame where you were mid-thought, not mid-pose. Use it everywhere people find you.

Name field
STEP 06

Your name, plus what you're known for. CORE

This is where your role belongs (Step 03). The field holds 30 characters and is searchable. "Dana Reyes | Brand Strategist" is found by people looking for a strategist. "Dana Reyes" is found only by people who already know her.

Bio
STEP 07

Line one is your point of view. Then proof. Then a door. CORE

You get 150 characters. Line one comes from Step 04, written for the person you want to reach. Irma's short form works well: *I help ___ through ___*. Line two is one proof a stranger would recognize. Line three is the next step, pointing down at your link.

D keep one personal line, but put it last.

Voice words
STEP 08

Choose three words for how you want to be felt.

"Not how you want to appear, but how you want another person to experience your presence." Clear, grounded, warm. Precise, cinematic, calm. Every caption gets checked against them.

Voice Test
STEP 09

Three questions before anything goes live. CORE

Would I say this in real life? Am I communicating or proving? Is there one truer sentence? If a line fails, cut it. The truer sentence is usually shorter.

B run every caption from your last month through this test.

BEFORE

Founder | Speaker | Coach 🚀
Helping people reach their full potential
Husband · Dad · Coffee lover

AFTER

I help founders raise their first round without giving up control.
60+ rounds closed for clients
Book a strategy call ↓

Same expert. The second version says who it's for, proves it once, and shows a stranger the door.

MAKE EVERY POST EVIDENCE.

FROM THE BOOK
IRMA LION · CHAPTER 07

Brand is the space between intention and evidence. Intention begins the direction. Evidence creates trust.

Three steps. Two core. Your bio makes a claim. Your posts, grid and highlights prove it. As Irma writes, you build a reputation *"by creating experiences that make other people choose those words for you."*

Captions

STEP 10

Write every post with the FRAME Story Method. CORE

Irma's structure for honest stories, used here as a caption. Keep a note called Story Bank, as the book suggests: one line every time a moment stays with you, so you never start from a blank page.

- **F** **Find the moment.** Your first line. Something specific that happened. Only about 125 characters show before "more," so start in the scene.
- **R** **Reveal the feeling.** What you felt but didn't say.
- **A** **Ask what changed.** The point. One idea per post.
- **M** **Mirror the reader.** Where they might see their own life.
- **E** **Extend the invitation.** One ask, matched to the reader. New viewers: *send or save.* Followers: *comment a word.* Ready buyers: *book or apply.*

A add one sentence to every image that says why it matters.

Visual language

STEP 11

Begin with a feeling, not a palette.

"Do not begin with a palette. Begin with a feeling." Choose three emotions and three kinds of light, and shoot to them. The aim is not identical posts. It is *"the sense that different work comes from the same eye."* Your grid's top row, now previewed in a taller 3:4 frame, should feel like one eye made it.

The tour

STEP 12

Highlights, links and pins that walk a stranger to you. CORE

Five highlights, in this order. Your first link is the one action you want. Pin three posts: your point of view, your proof, your offer.

01	02	03	04	05
START HERE	RESULTS	METHOD	KIND WORDS	WORK WITH ME
Who you are, who you help	Client wins, numbers	How you work	Testimonials	The offer, how to start

B one link only, for thirty days.

YOUR NEXT SHOOT · FROM IRMA'S SHOT LIST

Portrait. Process. Environment. Detail. Honest imperfection. Pick four for your next session, and every post has a reason to exist.

THE TOOLS

SEE YOURSELF AS A STRANGER DOES.

Irma's work began when she turned the camera on herself. Do the same. Open your profile logged out, or on a friend's phone. Run this now, then every Monday for a month.

THE PROFILE

- [ ] My photo is recent, close and unperformed.
- [ ] My name field says what I'm known for.
- [ ] Bio line one states what I believe, for whom.
- [ ] My bio has one piece of proof.
- [ ] My first link is the one action I want.

THE WORK

- [ ] Five highlights, intro first, offer last.
- [ ] My point of view, proof and offer are pinned.
- [ ] My last three captions pass the Voice Test.
- [ ] Each recent post has exactly one ask.
- [ ] A stranger could say what I stand for.

Eight or more: you're ready for Private Preview 02. **Five to seven:** return to the Core steps. **Under five:** start at Lesson 1 and give it one afternoon.

THE TRACKER · FOUR NUMBERS, TWO MINUTES A WEEK, FROM YOUR INSIGHTS

	WEEK 1	WEEK 2	WEEK 3	WEEK 4
Profile visits				
Follows from your profile				
Link taps				
DMs about working together				

IF IT IS NOT WORKING

WHAT HAPPENED	WHAT TO CHANGE NEXT MONDAY
Visits, but few follows	Rewrite bio line one. Visitors aren't seeing themselves in it.
Follows, but no DMs	Your invitation is missing. Add one warm ask a week and check your Work with me highlight.
Link taps, but no inquiries	The page doesn't match the promise. Make the link title and page headline say the same thing.
Posting feels forced	Go back to Lesson 1. In Irma's words: *"A new strategy will not fix a disconnection from yourself."*

MEET THE HOUSE

ONE HOUSE. THREE FOUNDERS.

ID House Inc. is a luxury brand agency for founders and experts. Strategy, image and revenue, built as one system around you, by the three people who run it.



Niko Trimino

CO-FOUNDER · CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER (COO)

Niko leads operations and technology. He builds the systems, automation and operating rhythm behind every brand, so projects move in half the typical time.

Operating advisor across 45+ industries



Irma Lion

CO-FOUNDER · CHIEF CREATIVE OFFICER (CCO)

Irma decides how the world sees you. Nearly two decades directing fashion and editorial work, and the author of *The Art of Being in the Frame*.

Leads the image and creative direction of every brand



Christian Trimino

CO-FOUNDER · CHIEF STRATEGY OFFICER (CSO)

Christian leads strategy and the path to revenue. His standard is extreme hospitality, and he builds it into your business so your clients feel seen and ready to buy.

$100M+ in sales managed and closed

$100M+
SALES MANAGED AND CLOSED

3,000+
SALES PROFESSIONALS TRAINED

250+
CEOS, FOUNDERS & CREATORS

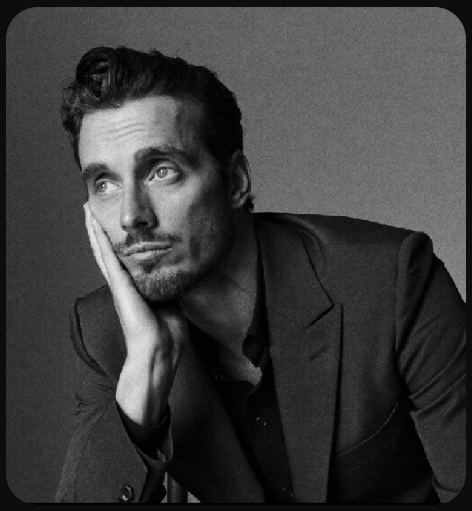
45+
INDUSTRIES ADVISED

~20 yrs
EDITORIAL CREATIVE DIRECTION

You work directly with all three founders. No account managers and no hand-offs. The people on this page are the people on your project.

IF YOUR BRAND STILL LOOKS SMALLER THAN YOU

YOU DON'T GET A MEDAL FOR DOING IT ALONE.



That's the title of a chapter near the end of Irma's book. It's also why ID House exists.

This preview fixes the surface. If you've done every step and your brand still doesn't look like the person your clients meet in the room, the gap is deeper: the message, the image, or the offer underneath it.

FROM THE BOOK
IRMA LION · CHAPTER 15

Sometimes the most supportive thing you can do for your brand is to let someone who understands visual language help you translate what you feel into what people can see. That's not vanity. That's communication.

That is the work we do. Not a photographer, a designer and a strategist who never speak. One house, one vision, every piece in the frame.

01
IDENTITY
Positioning, point of view, voice and story.

02
IMAGE
An editorial shoot, art-directed by Irma.

03
INFLUENCE
Your profile rebuilt and weekly content, done for you.

04
INCOME
Offers, pricing, lead capture and a sales process.

YOUR NEXT STEP

APPLY TO WORK WITH ID HOUSE.

About four minutes. Every application is reviewed by the founders, with a response within two business days. Limited brands each quarter.

STEP INTO THE FRAME → IDHOUSEINC.COM

THE FRAME IS NOT WHERE YOU HIDE. IT IS WHERE YOU ARRIVE.

Irma Lion, The Art of Being in the Frame

The full book is coming soon. Reply to the email this preview came in, and you'll be the first to know. · Next: Private Preview 02, *From Being Seen to Being Paid.* How to turn what you've built into income. · Platform details current as of November 2026; Instagram changes often. © 2026 ID House Inc. · team@idhouseinc.com · @id.house.inc